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Purpose/Policy:

This “Can Line Air Rinser” standard operating procedure has been created to assist operators with setup, operations, changeover, cleaning, and troubleshooting.

Scope:

The “Air Rinser” requires two in/out blocks for operations (size dependent) and includes 3 “Air Rinser” nozzles that blow air into the can to remove any debris. Ensure the E-Stop is pressed prior to setting up the unit.

The purpose of the “Air Rinser” is to remove debris from the inside of prepackaged cans. The machine operates by using forced air to blow out the cans with positively charged ions.

Definitions/Acronyms:

- SOP – Standard Operating Procedure
- PPE – Personal Protective Equipment
- E-Stop – Emergency Stop button
- Air Rinser – Machine that blows ionized air into cans to remove debris before filling
- Warmer – Steam tunnel that warms filled cans to help mitigate condensation

Authorities/Responsibilities:

This SOP can be completed by an entry level packaging operator after proper training from a senior member of the Can line packaging team. The objective of this SOP is to gain the knowledge needed to operate the “Can Line Air Rinser” and trouble shoot any issues that may arise.

Resources and Materials:

Operations:

- Voltage Tester
- Cotton Swabs
- Isopropyl Alcohol

Changeovers:

- 12oz in/out blocks.
- 16oz in/out blocks.
- 19.2oz in/out blocks.

Basic Cleaning:

- Cotton Swabs and Isopropyl for air rinse nozzles.

Deep Clean:

- Refer to SOP Document: Can line Zone 4 Cleaning
    - N:\Operations\Production\Boston\Packaging\Canning Line\Canning 2025\Zone Cleaning 2025\Can Line Upper Level\Zone 4 - Warmer Area

Troubleshooting:

- No Equipment required.

PPE Required:

- No formal PPE required suggested nitrate gloves for cleaning.

Procedures:

Setting up the Air Risner

1. Determine the can size you are running.
    1.1 Once you have determined the can size, correlate the size of the blocks to the size of the cans.
    1.2 There are sets of 12oz, 16oz, and 19.2oz blocks.
2. Once blocks are in place, bring cans up to the first set of belts before the first block.
3. Using the wheel attached to the first belt station, open the belts up and place a can between them.
4. Tighten the belts using the wheel until you have a snug like fit for the can. You should still be able to move the can vertically a bit.
    4.1 *NOTE*: Over tightening can cause damage to cans and being too loose will not allow them to travel through the belts properly.
5. Spray Isopropyl Alcohol onto a swab and clean out the inside of the air nozzle ports before operation.
6. Turn on the air rinser by undoing the E-stop on the electrical cabinet located in front of the rinser.
7. Press the start button on the right side of the same cabinet.
8. Using a voltage meter, check to make sure you are getting positive voltage by moving it over the air nozzles.
9. If no voltage is present, contact maintenance. If there is voltage present, proceed to the next step.
10. Press the stop button on the electrical cabinet.
11. You are now ready to start the operation process.

Operation of the Air Rinser Unit

1. Once cans are staged and ready to be brought through the rinser, undo the E-Stop.

2. Press Start. This will automatically bring cans through the rinser if the filler is calling for cans.
3. Watch the cans to ensure they are not tipping and or getting crushed.
4. If they are, refer to the “Setting up the Air Rinser” portion of this SOP.
5. Ensure cans are getting date coded.

Changeover Guide

1. Remove previous block size by undoing the two-twist knobs the blocks are attached with.
2. Store removed blocks in appropriate area.
3. Add new blocks (new size) to “Air Rinser” and tighten down the two-twist knobs for each block.

Shutting Down Air Rinser

1. Ensure all cans are cleared out.
2. Press the stop button on the side of the electrical cabinet.
3. Press the E-Stop.

Basic Cleaning of the Air Rinser

1. When you clean the air rinser, inspect the belts for wear and tear.
2. Wipe down all surfaces with a slightly damp cloth.
3. Dry all surfaces with a soft dry cloth.
4. Spray Isopropyl Alcohol onto a swab and clean out the inside of the air nozzle ports.
5. Cleaning has been completed.

Deep Cleaning

1. Refer to SOP Document: Can line Zone 4 Cleaning
    1.1 N:\Operations\Production\Boston\Packaging\Canning Line\Canning 2025\Zone Cleaning 2025\Can Line Upper Level\Zone 4 - Warmer Area.

Forms:

Not Applicable

Reference Documents:

Not Applicable

Common Issues:

1. In the event of “can jam” please follow the following guide:
    1.1 Press the stop button on the electrical cabinet, followed by the E-Stop button.

1.2 Turn of conveyor belt prior to the twist rinser.
  1.2.1 To do this, turn the red handle of the electrical box to the off position.
1.3 Open the drive belts by using the star wheel connected to the drive belts.
1.4 Remove all damaged cans from the drive belt area and inside the twist rinser blocks and proceed to recycle them.
1.5 Once all damaged cans have been removed from the machine, proceed to take one good can and place it in between the drive belts.
1.6 Tighten drive belts with the star wheel until you feel resistance from the can inside the drive belts.
1.7 Remove can and recycle.
1.8 Proceed to turn on the power for the conveyor belts using the red handle on the electrical box.
1.9 Undo E-Stop and press the green start button on the side of the electrical cabinet.
  1.9.1 Verify that the cans are getting date coded correctly to finish trouble shooting guide.

Document History and Approval:

Revise document history as described in the table and key below.

(Reference to following document: B1C.SOP.P001: Document Control and Approval Procedure Template)

VERSION NO.	VERSION DATE	DESCRIPTION OF CHANGE	AUTHOR NAME/PROJECT MANAGER
001	2024/03/05		Kyle Szymanski
002	2026/10/26	Updated SOP to Newest Layout Version	Kyle Szymanski

Version Approval Number: 002

Approved by: Kyle Szymanski

Position Title: OSCI Manager

Date: 10/26/26